

pleted torrents will go. You can also set up a Watch Directory that will allow you to drop torrent files right into a specific folder on your NAS and it will immediately start downloading them. You can save the settings when you're done.

► **Using your smartphone or tablet with your network-attached storage**

Now comes the interesting part – there will be times when you would want to upload or download files from your network-attached storage device using your smartphone or tablet computer. You may even treat the NAS simply as a network transfer point for your data. In this section we'll tell you how to use your smartphone with your NAS.

How to do it

When it comes to shifting or syncing multimedia files like music or images, different NAS may follow different methods. Some network-attached storage devices may use a web front for the file collections whereas others may implement certain extensions to DLNA for uploading and downloading some media files. These environments don't necessarily provide a consistent or ideal user experience for the mobile device user, due to a number of factors. Typically this is due to a web front that is optimised for desktop use only. In certain cases, the DLNA server and client apps may not offer the proper sync or file-transfer functionality.

SMB file-manager apps

The recommended method for this task is the SMB/CIFS network file handling, because of various reasons:

- It's supported by every network-attached storage device thanks to Linux's SAMBA software.
- Even the USB-linked file servers support SMB as well as the internet HTTP and FTP file transfer protocols.
- This has been a standard for regular computing devices with the Microsoft Windows Platform, as well as Linux and Apple Macintosh platform, for a long time.

The platform-based mobile devices have joined the SMB party through the use of SMB-enabled file-manager apps. These are typically low-cost or free apps that expose the mobile device's file system